

NIGHTMARE THE LUNATIC

THIS ROGUELIKE ISN'T ROGUELIKE

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There are four elements that make a roguelike game. Difficulty, perma-death, replayability, and upgrades. Some roguelike games check all of those boxes. Take Hades for example. Now, we aren't comparing Hades with all the other roguelike games nor are we saying that Hades is THE BEST roguelike game ever made. The game comes with its own set of flaws. We're just saying that out of the four factors mentioned above, if a game fails to tick even one box, said game isn't really a roguelike. The game in question is Nightmare: The Lunatic. It is the new roguelike on the block and we're gonna tell you why this roguelike isn't a roguelike.

Nightmare: The Lunatic was released on January 7th, 2022 on Steam. The game was released in early access and it still is in early access. Nobody has picked it up and marketed it nor is anyone famous playing it. It's just sitting on the Steam listings - on the sidelines. So, why did we pick it up and review it? Well, to put it mildly, because this game is weird.

STORY

The main character of this game is a nameless faceless guy who just happens to get stuck in his dream – a nightmare, to be precise. He finds

himself waking up in a dungeon with multiple platforms. With no idea where to go, he starts roaming around, exploring all the different platforms. Suddenly, he bumps into a Dream Merchant who also happens to be stuck in the same nightmare with him. The merchant came there to trade but unfortunately (or fortunately) got stuck in this never ending nightmare too. The main character and the Dream Merchant decide to work together and get out of this never ending nightmare. You see, you cannot just wake up from this nightmare. It is never ending. Which means that the only way out is to dig deeper and hopefully find an exit.

The story is okay and it does provide a decent base for the game to rest upon and everything makes just a little bit more sense if you know the story. However, at the same time, even if the story wasn't there and the player started directly from level 1, it wouldn't have mattered. What we're trying to say is that the story does not provide a good enough reason for the player to be interested in the game. And the absence of "story elements" throughout the game just adds fuel to the fire.

GAMEPLAY

There are several gameplay elements which we liked and disliked about the game. Gameplay is this game's strongest point. One big advantage that this game has over the others is the fact that you can use a controller without having a severe disadvantage while playing the game. Let us explain. You see, most roguelike games REQUIRE a precise aiming device i.e. the good ol mouse. Nightmare: The Lunatic changes this up by giving you three ways to play the game. If you're a hardcore keyboard fanatic and just don't want to take



your hands off of it then the "Keyboard Only" setting will be perfect for you. If you prefer the good old keyboard + mouse then this game has got a separate control scheme for that too and lastly, this game also has